

KALE REALTY

ZILLOW PAID \$100 MILLION TO DISAPPEAR A RIVAL.

The FTC confirmed it yesterday. Here's the mistake it exposes in how you find leads.

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**THE PLATFORM
RUNNING YOUR
LEADS JUST GOT
CAUGHT BUYING
OUT ITS OWN
COMPETITION.**

Zillow paid Redfin \$100 million in 2025 to stay out of a market for nine years. The FTC settled the case August 24.

ONE COMPANY CONTROLLING THE MARKET ISN'T A GLITCH. IT'S THE PLAN.

The FTC's own settlement lays it out: in February 2025 Zillow paid Redfin \$100 million, and Redfin agreed to shut down its rental-listings business and hand its customers to Zillow for up to nine years. Five states joined the case. The order announced August 24 forces Redfin back into the market within six months, because regulators decided one company controlling that much of it was the actual problem. Most agents never think about who owns the platform they feed listings to every day. This settlement is the reminder that the answer isn't neutral.

WHAT ACTUALLY PROTECTS YOUR PIPELINE FROM ONE COMPANY'S DECISIONS:

- 1 Keep your own client database current, not just your CRM's default view.**

It's the one list no portal can throttle or resell around you.

- 2 Track where your last ten leads actually came from.**

If one source built more than half of that list, that's your exposure.

- 3 Put one hour a week into a channel you own.**

Past clients, referral partners, your own site. Nothing that depends on someone else's algorithm.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE FTC JUST PROVED THE PLATFORM ISN'T NEUTRAL.

Your pipeline shouldn't depend on it being one.